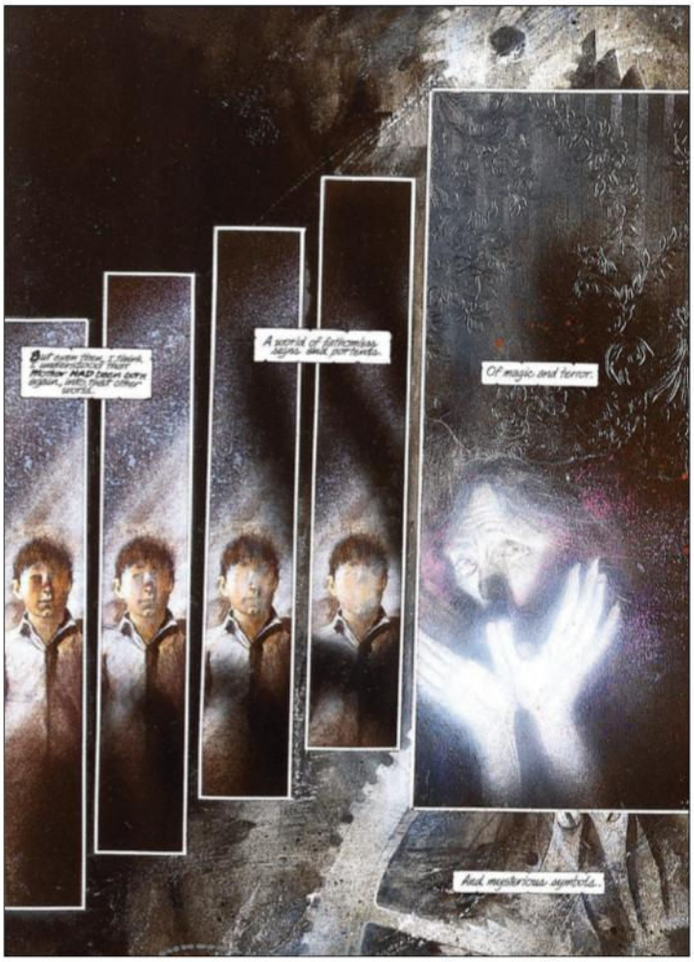
ARKHAM ASYLUM: A SERIOUS HOUSE ON SERIOUS EARTH

Details **Originally published** Arkham Asylum: A Serious House On Serious Earth (1989) **Publisher** DC
Writer Grant Morrison **Artist** Dave McKean **Collected in** Arkham Asylum: A Serious House On Serious Earth
Available digitally Comixology, iBookstore



Arkham Asylum takes a much darker look at both Batman and Bruce Wayne, throwing man and mask up against a wall and looking at the different shadows they cast. It was the book that defined the more gothic direction the Batman franchise would travel through the Nineties, Grant Morrison using the imposing architecture of the eponymous Arkham Asylum to frame an introspective journey through Wayne's broken psyche.

With references to Sigmund Freud and his structural theory of the mind, Carl Jung and his psychological archetypes and constant call-backs to the multiple fairy tales and folklore *Batman* built on, *Arkham Asylum* manages to succinctly define Bruce Wayne (and the villains he encounters). The fractal and unconventional art of Dave McKean punctuates Morrison's grim narrative, and the loose panels often carry far more impact than the text supporting them. This is a more realistic confrontation of what Batman is than we've seen in any other run, and the graphic novel beautifully conveys the chaos, doubt and polarity that's intrinsic to Batman's character.



